

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

Research is meant to benefit society by raising public awareness and creating products and innovations that enhance development. For research to serve its full purpose, the results must leave the confines of research laboratories and academic journals.

Findings effectively communicated can go a long way to serve the interests of the public. They can help address social injustices or improve treatments offered to patients.

Many researchers seem to be content with sharing the results of their studies in academic journals or conferences. But few journals allow everybody to read the findings. Even articles freely available are usually written in academic language incomprehensible to the average reader.

For researchers in the tenure-track system, their main goal is winning tenure, which in part can be achieved by getting a number of papers published in prominent journals. Pressures like this mean community-level outreach is not prioritised.

Many researchers lack the writing skills to describe their results to a general audience. They may also worry about whether the public will understand their findings, or about findings being used to influence controversial policies. These concerns cause some researchers to shy away from communicating their findings outside the academic community.

Propagating research findings beyond academic publications is particularly crucial for addressing certain social discrepancies. It can help families, communities, healthcare providers, policymakers, government agencies and other stakeholders to understand and respond to crises that plague society.

The benefits of sharing findings flow both ways. Engaging with other researchers and the public can lead to unexpected new connections and new ideas that could suggest fruitful new directions for research.

To benefit both researchers and the communities, the need to find innovative, accessible ways to share the work cannot be overstated.

Institutions and funding organisations should support more researchers to publish in open access journals so that the public doesn't have to pay to read them. Institutions and researchers should invest in partnerships that expand capacity for sharing results more broadly.

Furthermore, ethics committees should make it mandatory for researchers to share their results with the public. Every research participant should opt in or out of receiving results, as part of the process of giving informed consent.

There could be misunderstanding of the findings presented by the researcher because of technical terminology. This can be resolved by researchers engaging the services of professional writers or communication officers to help with translating their study into more accessible language and share it widely with media outlets and the public.

Sharing results with the people who are most affected by them makes us better researchers and ensures that our work can be used to improve people's lives. Institutions and collaborators must recognise the value of doing so.

- A) With researchers being aware of public interests.
 - B) With its findings published in prominent journals.
 - C) With researchers creating products that enhance social development.
 - D) With its findings properly communicated beyond the academic circle.
- Why do ordinary readers find it difficult to access the results of researchers' studies?
- A) They cannot understand the academic language used for reporting these results.
 - B) They feel intimidated by the jargon researchers use to describe their findings.
 - C) They do not attend conferences where these results are freely available.
 - D) They have few chances to locate the journals that publish these findings.

What is one of the reasons some researchers won't prioritise communicating their findings to the public?

- A) They can thrive on the papers published.
- B) Their top consideration is to win tenure.
- C) Their main goal is gaining recognition in their field.
- D) They have to struggle to reach out to the community.

How can sharing findings benefit researchers themselves?

- A) By helping them to identify new research directions.
- B) By enabling them to understand crises plaguing society.
- C) By enabling them to effectively address social discrepancies.
- D) By helping them to forge ties with government agencies.

Why are researchers advised to engage the services of professional writers or communication officers?

- A) To satisfy ethics committees' mandatory requirements of researchers.
- B) To translate their study into languages accessible to readers overseas.
- C) To make their publications correctly understood by the public.
- D) To render their findings acceptable by prominent journals.

Page Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

Spiders make their presence felt in late August and through early autumn. This is the mating season of some of the most common varieties, when male house spiders come out of hidden corners to look for females, and when garden spiders reach adult size and spin their most dazzling webs.

Yet while the spider is a familiar fixture of nursery poems or songs and Halloween decorations, its relationship with humans is complicated. Fear of spiders is common and has serious impacts on the lives of sufferers. Its prevalence appears unrelated to any rational assessment of risk. Spiders in the UK are almost all harmless. Farmland species perform valuable ecosystem services, by preying on insects that are our competitors and crop pests. But they are a constant source of human anxieties—with a cultural association with witches and superstitions dating back to the middle ages.

Does this perhaps explain, in part, the lack of data about how spiders are faring in our age of ecological crisis? British butterflies are the most studied group of insects in the world, due to the long tradition of collecting and observing them. But spider conservationists point out that it was only in the 1980s that the classification of house spiders was properly sorted out. And while information about insect populations is gathered by experiments that measure the numbers hitting windscreens or traps, there have been few attempts to count spiders.

The huge reductions in the numbers of flying insects can only mean a reduction in spiders' food supply. A recent landmark study identified a 75% fall in insect populations between 1989 and 2016, with pesticide use

spiders is worrying, as it is for most creatures. But conservationists are most concerned about those varieties that are threatened due to habitat loss and fragmentation, which makes it impossible for them to migrate.

Of around 650 spider species regularly recorded in the UK, the majority thrive in marshes and wastelands. Conservation efforts, often led by determined individuals, have helped some species to recover by reintroducing them to new areas. With rewilding now firmly on the environmental policy agenda, the hope is that in future spiders will be enabled to migrate by themselves, adapting to climate change by moving along wildlife corridors.

It seems unlikely that spiders will ever attract the same level of human enthusiasm as bees, birds or butterflies, in spite of their unique status as nature's spinners. But as they reveal themselves in all their splendour this autumn, it would be a good thing if more animal lovers recognised the ways in which spiders are simply magnificent.

What do we learn about spiders in the UK since the middle ages?

- A) They have been generally misconceived.
- B) They have adversely impacted crop growth.
- C) They have been a constant reminder of bad luck.
- D) They have made their presence felt when spinning webs.

What have spiders been associated with in the UK for centuries?

- A) Harm.
- B) Evil.
- C) Suffering.
- D) Aggression.

What partly accounts for the reduction in spiders' food supply?

- A) The long tradition of collecting insects.
- B) Fast reproduction of their competitors.
- C) Chemicals used for killing insects.
- D) The extinction of a lot of wildlife.

What does the passage say is conservationists' biggest worry?

- A) A variety of spiders are threatened due to pollution of marshes and wasteland.
- B) Certain species of spiders are endangered due to loss of their natural homes.
- C) An increasing number of spiders are being killed by deadly pesticides.
- D) More and more spider species are found losing their ability to migrate.

What wish does the author express close to the end of the passage?

- A) More people would recognise spiders' unique status in the ecosystem.
- B) People would show greater enthusiasm for spiders than for butterflies.
- C) There would be sufficient corridors for spiders to move along.
- D) There would be more people appreciating spiders' splendour.